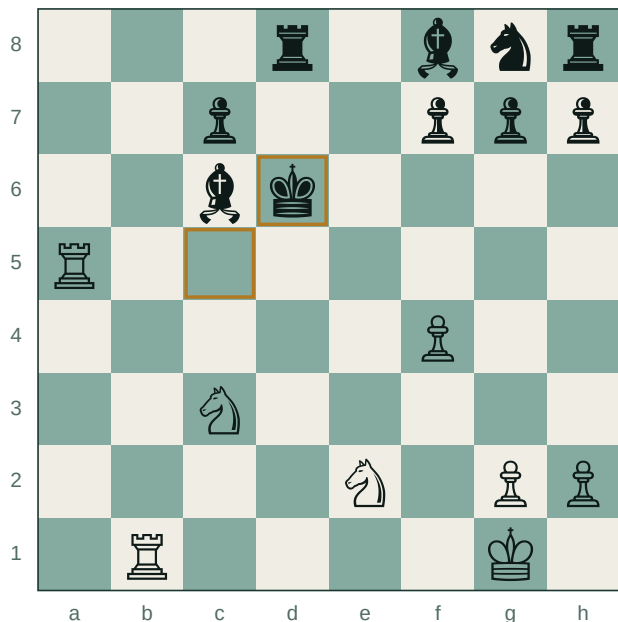


Deflection tactics: White, move 22

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 21...Kd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Rd1+ Ke7 23. Re5+ Kf6 24. Rxd8

22.Rd1+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **22...Ke7**.

23.Re5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **23...Kf6**.

24.Rxd8 The rook captures the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on d6. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on d8. Check for tactical protection.